

Picking winners

Hi,
Congratulations on the article 'A Cut Above' in your December issue. I have always loved Digit because of the hardware reviews and I think that you covered every category of hardware in this story. I am sure that I will be referring to this issue many times in the future.

I would like to know more about the process you followed in picking out the winners. And lastly, are all of the products mentioned in Digit still available for purchase?

CHETAN

Via e-mail



digit

Hi Chetan,

The Digit Zero1 Awards is our way of rewarding the best products (on the basis of performance and features) in the Indian market. These products are tested by our Test Centre during the course of the year. We considered every single product that we had reviewed between January and December 2001. These products were compared purely on the basis of performance and the features offered. Our panel of reviewers came up with a shortlist of three products in each category from which a winner was chosen. Price was not a criteria—performance was. The product with the best absolute performance was adjudged the winner. Hope this clarifies the Digit Test Process for you.

Calling Agent 001

Hi,
I have been reading your magazine for almost one year and wait eagerly for its arrival every month. My favourite section is Undercover, which I like because of the insider market information that it provides. How can I contact Agent 001 with my queries?

SAVIO

Via e-mail

digit

Dear Savio,

Agent 001 wishes to remain incognito so that he is free to investigate without being recognised. Also, since he's constantly on the move, gathering the latest bit of information that he needs for Undercover, we'd be unable to provide you with a contact address. If you would like to ask a question about which products to buy please address your e-mail to readersletters@jasubhai.com and we'll be sure to pass it on. Who knows? Perhaps next month's Undercover will answer your question.

Priced for piracy

Dear Karan,
Over the last three years or so since I bought my first PC, there's been a lot of change in the computer industry. Most of this change has been positive, from my perspective as a PC user. Today I have a wider range of products to choose from with awesome performance—I can't begin to compare the performance of my long discarded 2 MB PCI graphics card with the 32 MB GeForce2MX card that I have now. Most importantly, the price of hardware has dropped enormously which has made it more affordable for me.

On the software side, however, things are not so rosy. New versions of software seem to get more and more expensive without adding many additional features. How is it that companies such as Microsoft continue to raise the prices of their operating system and other software? As long as software vendors continue to display this kind of attitude they have no reason to complain about piracy.

VARUN

Via e-mail

digit

Dear Varun,

Pricing and piracy are not issues that can be linked together. This is something that we often do to convince ourselves that software companies are unjust, but the argument doesn't really hold any water.

While you are right when you say that software upgrades seem to get more and more expensive, it is not incumbent upon you to upgrade unless the additional features are worth paying for. I am sure that this was something you considered before upgrading to the GeForce graphics card that you've mentioned.

Piracy of software is more about the unwillingness to pay for a product than it is about the price itself. Take the example of software such as games. Unlike in the past, today buying a game is pretty reasonable even in a country like India. That doesn't stop most people from 'borrowing' a friend's game-pack and making a copy for themselves.

However, you do have an option. If you think that Microsoft or any other vendor charges unreasonably, just switch to a free, stable alternative—Linux. The best form of protest against unreasonable pricing is to refuse to purchase it. Piracy is not a justification.

Fully content

Hi Karan,
I decided to try out Digit magazine in Oman with your November issue. I was initially very reluctant to buy your magazine because I thought it would be India-centric and because it cost twice as much as the retail price here.

Well, all I have to say is that I am very impressed! This magazine is good enough to be confused with any international computer magazine, as that policeman in the Digit Diary said last time! Thanks.

EDGAR SANZ

Via e-mail

digit

Dear Edgar,

I am glad you enjoyed reading Digit. Your e-mail is an affirmation that our attempts to make this a magazine with world-class content have paid off.